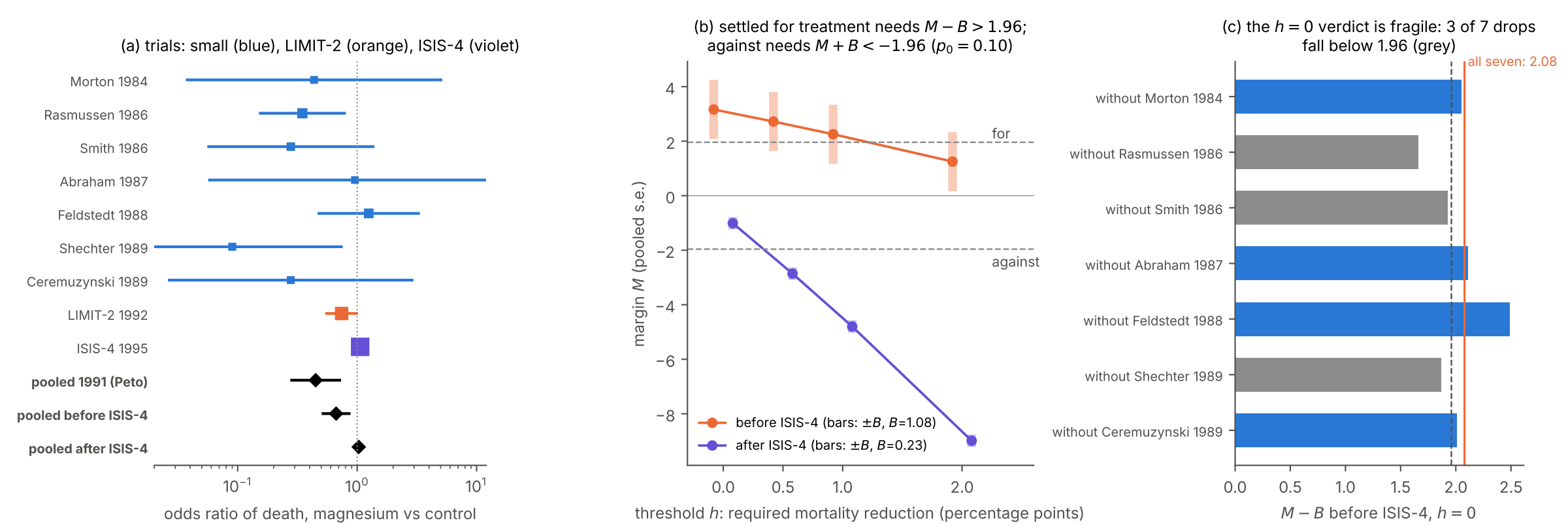
(a) trials: small (blue), LIMIT-2 (orange), ISIS-4 (violet)
Morton 1984
Rasmussen 1986
Smith 1986
Abraham 1987
Feldstedt 1988
Shechter 1989
Ceremuzynski 1989
LIMIT-2 1992
ISIS-4 1995
pooled 1991 (Peto)
pooled before ISIS-4
pooled after ISIS-4
10^{-1}
10^{0}
10^{1}
odds ratio of death, magnesium vs control
(b) settled for treatment needs $M - B > 1.96$; against needs $M + B < -1.96$ ($p_0 = 0.10$)
margin M (pooled s.e.)
4
2
0
−2
−4
−6
−8
for
against
before ISIS-4 (bars: ±B, B=1.08)
after ISIS-4 (bars: ±B, B=0.23)
0.0
0.5
1.0
2.0
threshold h: required mortality reduction (percentage points)
(c) the $h = 0$ verdict is fragile: 3 of 7 drops fall below 1.96 (grey)
all seven: 2.08
without Morton 1984
without Rasmussen 1986
without Smith 1986
without Abraham 1987
without Feldstedt 1988
without Shechter 1989
without Ceremuzynski 1989
0.0
0.5
1.0
1.5
2.0
2.5
$M - B$ before ISIS-4, $h = 0$